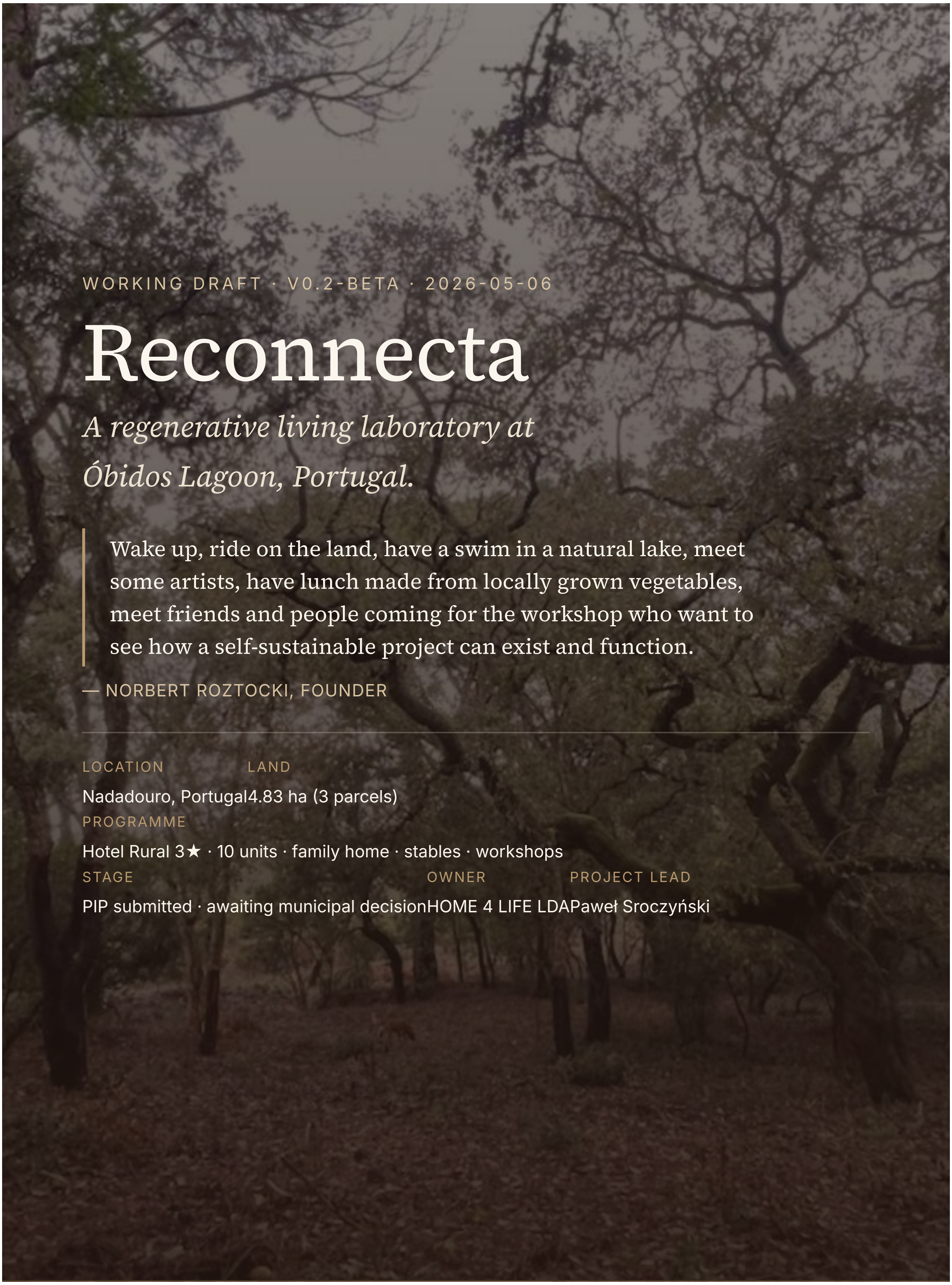

WORKING DRAFT · V0.2-BETA · 2026-05-06

Reconnecta

A regenerative living laboratory at Óbidos Lagoon, Portugal.

> Wake up, ride on the land, have a swim in a natural lake, meet some artists, have lunch made from locally grown vegetables, meet friends and people coming for the workshop who want to see how a self-sustainable project can exist and function.

— NORBERT ROZTOCKI, FOUNDER

LOCATION	LAND
Nadadouro, Portugal	4.83 ha (3 parcels)

PROGRAMME

Hotel Rural 3★ · 10 units · family home · stables · workshops

STAGE	OWNER	PROJECT LEAD
PIP submitted · awaiting municipal decision	HOME 4 LIFE LDA	Paweł Sroczyński

§ 01

Executive Summary

Reconnecta is a 4.83-hectare regenerative project under development on the western coast of Portugal, between Óbidos Lagoon and the Atlantic. Its purpose is to prove — at human scale and on a single piece of land — that uncompromising ecological practice and uncompromising quality of life are not opposites. They are the same craft, done well.

The project is organised around three interlocking commitments: a family home, a working ecosystem, and a place where others learn what it took to build it. The hospitality layer — a 10-unit Hotel Rural 3★, currently in the Portuguese pre-permit (PIP) stage — funds the operation. Workshops, residencies and a research programme give it meaning. The land itself — soils, water, oaks, horses, food — is both medium and message.

Reconnecta is being built by Norbert Roztocki and family, with Paweł Sroczyński as project manager. It is not a retreat centre, not a commune, not a brand. It is a place.

This document describes what is known, what is being designed, and what remains to be answered. Open questions are flagged in line as PENDING — ... and registered in §19 so they can be tracked rather than hidden.

§ 02

The Holistic Goal

Every design decision in this project is tested against a single sentence — the day Norbert wants this place to make possible:

> *Wake up, ride on the land, have a swim in a natural lake, meet some artists, have lunch made from locally grown vegetables, meet friends and people coming for the workshop who want to see how a self-sustainable project can exist and function.*

Behind that sentence sit three pillars:

QUALITY OF LIFE

Family home. Horses. Creativity. Guests. Community. Nature immersion. Freedom from dependency on external systems.

FORMS OF PRODUCTION

Accommodation revenue. Horsemanship workshops. Ecology and permaculture workshops. Food from the land. Energy from the land. Artist residencies and cultural programming.

FUTURE RESOURCE BASE

Self-sustaining land in 50–100 years. Healthy soil. Biodiverse native ecosystem. A model others can learn from and replicate.

The Holistic Goal is the constitution; everything that follows is implementation.

§ 03

Site & Topography

Location	Nadadouro, Caldas da Rainha municipality
From Óbidos Lagoon	~1,000 m
From Atlantic	~3,000 m
Owned area	4.83 ha across 3 parcels (4.02 + 1.56 + 0.94 ha)
Owner	HOME 4 LIFE LDA · acquired 2019-02-04
Cadastral artigos	3978, 3988, 3994
Adjacent rented	4–5 ha · terms PENDING — see §19, Q20
Total operational	up to 8–10 ha
Zoning	PDM — Espaço Agro-Florestal
Planning framework	Agrotourism DL 39/2008 · Article 61 PDM · accommodation cap ≤ 600 m² ABC
Topographic survey	TPG Lda (Pedro Agapito), 1:500 scale

Two zones

Upper section (~2 ha). Cleared ex-eucalyptus plantation. Heights 27–37 m. Average gradient ~5% over 200 m horizontal, slope facing **south-west** — warm, afternoon sun. The planned building zone. Soil is post-eucalyptus: degraded, clay/sand mix, compacted.

Lower section (~2 ha). Biodiverse, established native vegetation (oak, pine, local species). Heights 24–27 m. A seasonal stream runs through it. The PIP documents identify *zonas húmidas* (wetland zones) and multiple *linhas de água*. High ecological value, designated *preserve and enhance*.

Drainage. Upper section drains south-west toward the lower section's stream. Mediterranean–Atlantic hydrology: wet winters, dry summers. This is a design problem — capture, slow, store, distribute — not a resource problem.

Maps & access

PIP submission package includes cadastral plans, topographic survey, satellite aerial overlay, architectural site plans, full N–S and W–E cross-sections. Primary entry: east, from Travessa da Avé Maria. A second entry on the lower section is planned for horse and agricultural traffic, separating guest flows from operational flows.

§ 04

Land History

The land was acquired in February 2019 and has been in planning since. The upper section was a eucalyptus plantation before acquisition; the trees have since been cleared. Eucalyptus leaves a measurable legacy — soil acidification, allelopathic compounds that can persist five to ten years, and severe compaction — which directly drives the soil-remediation strategy in §8.

The lower section's pre-acquisition history is less clear. The native vegetation (oak, pine) suggests it was either never plantation-managed or has had decades to recover. A biologist has been engaged to conduct a full ecological survey (fauna, flora, invasives). An initial landscape and water assessment was delivered on 2026-04-28; further results are pending.

OPEN

- Q15 — When were the eucalyptus trees removed, and were the stumps chemically treated? Determines remediation timelines and whether residual herbicide testing is needed before food-bearing planting.
- Q29 — Detailed account of physical work undertaken between 2019 and present.

§ 05

People & Decisions

ROLE	PERSON	STATUS
Investor & strategic owner	Norbert Roztocki	Active
Project manager	Paweł Sroczyński	Active · PENDING — Q8 formal scope

ROLE	PERSON	STATUS
Architect	João Carlos Fonseca Jorge (OA #18423)	Engaged
Topographic surveyor	TPG Lda	Engaged
Biologist	Engaged	Survey in progress
Operational manager	—	**VACANT** · PENDING — Q9 critical hire
Family	Kamila + two children (12, 14)	Roles partial · PENDING — Q7

Norbert

Investor, kitesurfer, natural-horsemanship practitioner. Holds final strategic and financial authority. Present 6–8 months per year — strongest in the shoulder seasons (February–May, September–November). Away during winter and peak summer. Currently committing about 12 hours per week to project planning.

Kamila

Spouse, partner, parent. Functional role inside the operation is not yet defined. Co-decision-maker? Active on-site? The project's day-to-day stability — particularly during Norbert's absences — depends on this answer. PENDING — Q7

The vacancy that runs the place

A multi-enterprise operation (hospitality + horses + agriculture + workshops) requires presence 365 days a year. The brief: bilingual (Portuguese plus English/Polish), competent across horses, agriculture and hospitality. This person does not yet exist in the org. Recruitment in rural Portugal for this profile is itself a project. PENDING — Q9, Q10

Succession

Two paths held open: the children take over in time, or independent professional leadership succeeds the founder. Decided later, not now.

§ 06

Climate

This section is intentionally a placeholder. **No quantitative climate data has yet been collected for the parcel** beyond the regional understanding that this is Atlantic-Portugal Mediterranean: wet winters, dry summers, mild temperatures, coastal wind. Without numbers, none of the design layers downstream — water, planting, energy, fire — can be properly sized.

> REQUIRED FOR NEXT REVISION (IPMA STATION DATA ACCEPTABLE)
>
> - Q1 — Annual rainfall (mm/year) and monthly distribution
> - Q4 — Frost days per year, by month
> - Q5 — Prevailing wind directions and average / peak speeds
> - Q6 — Wildfire history (last 20 years) and PMDFCI fire-risk classification

The fire-risk question is the most consequential. This is ex-eucalyptus land in Atlantic Portugal, with the owner absent in July and August. A working fire plan is impossible to draft without the underlying classification — and irresponsible to defer beyond the next planning cycle.

§ 07

Water

The parcel is water-rich by Iberian standards — the design problem is capture, slowing, storage and distribution, not scarcity.

SOURCE	STATUS	NOTES
Municipal mains	Available	Reliable year-round; PIP confirms connection
Rainwater storage	Planned	Buffer + capture
Borehole	Planned	High-quality drinking water · APA licence PENDING — Q12
Seasonal stream	Existing	Wet-season flow; summer behaviour PENDING — Q13
Wetland & biological lakes	Planned (PIP)	Zonas húmidas identified; lagos biológicos on site plan

The stream and the wetland zones in the lower section are the project's most valuable hydrological asset. Biological lakes are shown as planned site features — places where slowed water becomes habitat.

Water demand. No formal demand calculation has been done yet. It needs livestock numbers (six Lusitanos + minor stock), irrigated areas (food forest, kitchen garden) and accommodation capacity (10 units, expected occupancy) to land. Downstream of PENDING — Q16, Q17 .

Borehole licensing. Drilling requires APA permit in Portugal. Application not yet initiated. PENDING — Q12

§ 08

Soil & Ecosystems

Soil zones

ZONE	QUALITY	PLAN
Upper native forest	Good, fertile	Preserve · no-touch
Post-eucalyptus (building / production)	Degraded, clay/sand, compacted	Active remediation · pioneer species, horse-manure cycling, mulching · 3–5 yr recovery
Lower / rented land	Sand/loam, better	Grazing + agriculture
Underlying geology	Heavy clay, site-wide	Drainage and compaction management throughout

The PIP states the agricultural area is *livre de contaminação química* — a legal declaration, not a laboratory result. **No formal soil tests have been conducted.** A baseline (pH, organic matter, NPK, heavy metals, compaction) is required before any planting design — both for credibility and because remediation cost is set by the answer. PENDING — Q14

Ecosystems

About two hectares of established native vegetation in the lower section: oak, pine, local Mediterranean species. The biologist's first-pass landscape and water assessment landed on 2026-04-28; full survey results — including the invasive-species baseline — are pending.

Adjacent to Óbidos Lagoon, the parcel sits in a documented bird corridor. The PIP notes proximity to herons, flamingos, storks, passerines and aquatic birds. Whatever is built here lives next to a Ramsar-grade ecosystem.

Watch-list. *Acacia dealbata* (silver wattle) is a regular invader on cleared land in this region. The biologist has been flagged.

§ 09

Architecture & Buildings

Programme (per PIP)

Hotel Rural 3★ — formal classification under Portuguese rural-tourism law. Ten units total, built across a main building and two secondary buildings.

Main building	Ground + 1st floor — 7 double rooms with private bathrooms
Secondary building A	Additional units
Secondary building B	Additional units
Total ABC (tourist)	600 m² (legal max under Article 61 PDM)
Building footprint	560 m²
Basement	Covered guest parking, breakfast room, staff areas, technical installations
Roof	Green roof (confirmed in PIP plans)

In addition: family home, stables, atelier/workshop complex, and ancillary outbuildings — see §20.

Status

- **Architect:** João Carlos Fonseca Jorge, OA #18423 (Serra d'El-Rei). Professional indemnity confirmed (Ageas Portugal, policy #008410215055, €50k cover).
- **Submission:** PIP submitted to Caldas da Rainha Câmara Municipal, January 2026.
- **Stage:** Pre-permit information request. Awaiting municipal response.
- **Risk:** Critical-path gate for construction. Rural Portuguese cycles run 6–18 months. PENDING — Q28 — contingency plan for 12-month delay.

Design principles

All buildings designed for **off-grid operation from day one**, with grid available as backup. Passive design first; technical systems sized to a load that has not yet been calculated (§10). Materials and detail follow the visual language collected on the Miro reference board (§13).

§ 10

Energy

Position: Start grid-connected → transition to fully off-grid (solar + wind + biomass).

Assets: ~300+ days of sun per year, coastal wind, an obvious south-west building aspect. The PIP shows a *central fotovoltaica* on the site plan. Infrastructure connections from Travessa da Avé Maria provide the backup grid path during build-out.

> **REQUIRED TO SIZE THE SYSTEM**
>
> - Q24 — Total electrical load (kW/kWh per day) at full operation
> - Battery storage capacity, inverter spec, redundancy
> - Phasing timeline (which buildings come online off-grid first)
> - Capital and ongoing maintenance budget

Until the load calculation lands, the energy section is a principle without a plan.

§ 11

Animals

ANIMAL	NUMBERS	NOTES
Horses (Lusitano)	up to 6	Native Portuguese breed, climate-adapted. Starting from zero — infrastructure first.
Chickens	TBD	Pest management + eggs
Dogs	1+	Property security and companionship
Goats	1–2	Browsing in degraded zones
Bees	Yes	Pollination + honey
Cow	Future	If space and capacity allow

No horse sales. Revenue from the equine layer is experiential — workshops in natural horsemanship — not livestock trade.

Grazing

Rotational paddocks across the lower section and rented land. Move horses between zones based on land condition. Full division design (paddock count, rotation intervals, rest periods) lands once carrying capacity is sized against climate and water data — downstream of §6 and §7.

A **round pen** is required for natural-horsemanship workshops; siting depends on soil drainage and proximity to the stables.

§ 12

Plants & Food Production

Philosophy. Full organic. No synthetic fertilisers. No synthetic plant-protection products. Ever. *Non-negotiable.*

System. Permaculture-based food forest plus kitchen garden. The food forest oriented toward perennial resilience; the kitchen garden toward family food sovereignty.

Fruit trees (confirmed viable for Atlantic Portugal): lemon, orange, cherry, apple, fig, peach.

Vegetables: carrot, salad, diverse mix.

Sequencing. Garden siting is deliberately not yet fixed. It happens *after* the water design (§7) and access design (§3), because correct sequence beats clever placement. Same principle governs the post-eucalyptus zone: pioneer species and soil remediation precede food-bearing planting by several seasons.

Goal. Family food sovereignty first; surplus to local community and (long-term) restaurant supply second.

§ 13

Aesthetic Direction

The visual constitution of the project lives on a Miro board curated by Norbert under the working title *taipa house / clay*. It is organised by category — **architecture, mass and elevation, roofs, kitchen, dining, atelier, sauna and wellness, materials, installations, outdoor kitchen, landscape, stables —** and represents the language the buildings, interiors and landscape should speak.

Visual reference (printed version): the board is interactive on the web edition of this document at enklava.co/projects/reconnecta. It contains category-organised image clusters covering architecture, mass and elevation, roofs, kitchen, dining, atelier, sauna and wellness, materials, installations, outdoor kitchen, landscape and stables.

Section in progress. Below: the categories that will receive their own page in the published whitepaper — one tile, one paragraph, one decision per category (what is being carried across, what is being left behind). Tiles remain as placeholders to mark the work still ahead.

ARCHITECTURE
MASS & ELEVATION
ROOFS
KITCHEN
DINING
ATELIER
SAUNA · WELLNESS
MATERIALS
INSTALLATIONS
OUTDOOR KITCHEN
LANDSCAPE
STABLES

§ 14

Economy & Funding

Revenue streams (named, not yet modelled)

STREAM	STAGE	NOTES
Hotel Rural 3★ accommodation	Near-term primary	10 units, short and longer stays
Natural-horsemanship workshops	Near-term	Norbert's core expertise — immediate asset
Ecology / permaculture workshops	Near-term	Norbert's network
Restaurant / food service	Long-term	Land-to-table, post-stabilisation
Artist residencies & cultural	Long-term	Mission, not margin
Licensing of replicable model	Aspirational	Geographic franchise

Financial position

Current revenue	Zero — fully in investment / build phase
Funding source	Norbert's personal company. No external investors. No bank financing.
Operating entity	HOME 4 LIFE LDA (commercial) — PENDING — Q18 reconcile with nonprofit framing
Build budget (next 12 months)	**€300,000 – €400,000**
Active costs	Architects, consultants, biologist, project management

Budget vs. scope — open tension

A single off-grid-ready accommodation unit in Portugal currently costs €60–80k. Ten units plus main house plus stables plus infrastructure plus water plus energy plus access — at credible 2026 costs — sits closer to **€800k–€1m+**. The €300–400k figure for the next 12 months is therefore either a phase-1 number (and the rest of the programme is on a multi-year capital plan) or scope must be staged more aggressively. Either way: an honest financial model with phasing is required before construction commitment. PENDING — Q16, Q17

Grants — opportunities not yet engaged

- **Portugal PEPAC 2023–2027** (CAP successor): agroforestry, agrotourism, young farmers
- **LIFE Programme** (EU): nature and biodiversity
- **EEA Grants** (Norway / Iceland / Liechtenstein): conservation
- **Portuguese environmental funds**: habitat restoration

Insurance

Architect's professional indemnity is in place. Property, guest liability, employer liability, equine/workshop liability — none yet planned. Six horses, workshop participants, visiting children: meaningful exposure. PENDING — Q19

§ 15

Vision: Five and Ten Years

Five years

Family home occupied. Horses on the land. Partners, friends and visitors living on-site short or medium term. Cultural activities running — artist residencies, music, gatherings. A local community hub where people from different sectors meet and connect.

Ten years

Same vision, deepened. Cycles and processes stable. Community settled. The core principle holds: *co-existing with nature, on independent food and independent energy, in collaboration with local communities and neighbours.*

Lifestyle pattern

- 6–8 months per year on the land
- Most productive shoulder seasons: February–May, September–November
- Away during winter and peak summer

Financial posture

Nonprofit framing. Self-sustaining after the investment phase. Not a profit centre. Open to biodiversity-focused conservation partners.

§ 16

Reference Projects

A March 2026 review benchmarked Reconnecta against ten Portuguese precedents:

PROJECT	LUXURY	OFF-GRID	RESEARCH	COMMUNITY	EDUCATION
Tamera	—	✓	★	★	★
Quinta do Rabaçal	★	★	—	◯	—
Vale das Estrelas	★	★	—	—	—
Terra Sangha	✓	✓	★	✓	✓
Terra Alta	—	✓	✓	✓	★

PROJECT	LUXURY	OFF-GRID	RESEARCH	COMMUNITY	EDUCATION
A Quinta da Lage	—	✓	—	★	✓
Vale Ondula	—	✓	✓	★	✓
Quinta do Vale	—	✓	✓	✓	✓
Orange Eco Land	◯	✓	—	✓	—
Tinhela610	★	✓	—	—	—
Reconnecta	★	★	★	★	★

The empty space. No single project in Portugal currently does what Reconnecta proposes. The luxury layer, the research layer, the community layer and the education layer all exist — but separately. Reconnecta sits at their intersection. That space, in the Portuguese market, is genuinely empty.

Closest references by axis: Luxury + off-grid → Quinta do Rabaçal, Vale das Estrelas, Tinhela610. Research + living lab → Tamera (water systems, 30 years of data), Terra Sangha. Community + education → Terra Alta, A Quinta da Lage, Vale Ondula.

§ 17

Values & Principles

Collaboration	The project is built, run and evolved through human partnership. Non-negotiable.
Natural alignment	Work with what is here — local conditions, local species, local community. No imposed systems.
Organic absolute	No synthetic fertilisers or plant-protection products. Ever.
Regeneration over productivity	Nonprofit framing removes profit pressure. Focus: biodiversity and ecosystem health.
Community as infrastructure	Neighbours = security network when Norbert is absent. Mutual aid. Shared machinery.
Non-dogmatic	No single -ism. Permaculture, biodynamics, organic agriculture — full deck of cards.

Non-negotiables: the land, and the approach.

§ 18

Roadmap & Next Steps

Primary deliverable

A comprehensive project roadmap with milestones — from current position to the five-year vision. Concrete checkpoints across all design layers: climate, geography, water, access, ecosystems, buildings, fencing, soils, economy and energy.

Technical deliverable

Off-grid / hybrid building architecture guidance. Every building designed to operate fully off-grid or on-grid, switchable. Includes passive design, solar/wind sizing, battery storage, water harvesting, composting/sewage systems — off-grid from day one with grid as backup during build-out.

Sequencing principles

1. Information before design (climate data, soil tests, water demand calc).
2. Permits before construction (PIP → full permit).
3. People before programme (operational manager hire before opening hospitality layer).
4. Soil before food (post-eucalyptus remediation precedes food-bearing planting).
5. Water before garden (capture and storage design before garden siting).
6. Insurance before operation (full coverage stack before guests, horses or workshops).

Active fronts (as of 2026-03-30)

1. **Land expansion.** Negotiating ~4–5 ha lease + 1 ha purchase from neighbours. Good progress.
2. **Building permit.** PIP submitted; awaiting municipal decision. Critical-path blocker.

A detailed phased roadmap is the next produced artefact, **after** the follow-up data session (§19).

§ 19

Open Questions

The diagnostic captured a strong qualitative picture. The follow-up below is the minimum information needed to convert the picture into a credible roadmap. Tags: *blocking* (no design possible without) or *important* (need but parallelisable).

🔴 Blocking — climate & geography

- **Q1** Annual rainfall (mm/year) and monthly distribution

- **Q4** Frost days per year, by month
- **Q5** Prevailing wind directions and speeds
- **Q6** Wildfire history + PMDFCI fire-risk classification

🔴 Blocking — people & operations

- **Q7** Kamila's role
- **Q8** Paweł's status, scope, authority
- **Q9** Operational-manager budget, salary, housing, search timeline
- **Q10** Who manages during 4–6-month absences
- **Q11** Labour budget beyond manager role

🔴 Blocking — water & soil

- **Q12** APA borehole licence — applied for?
- **Q13** Stream summer behaviour
- **Q14** Formal soil tests — commitment + target date
- **Q15** Eucalyptus removal date and stump treatment

🔴 Blocking — finance & legal

- **Q16** Projected annual operating costs at full operation
- **Q17** Occupancy rate and nightly-rate assumptions
- **Q18** Legal structure: HOME 4 LIFE LDA vs. nonprofit framing
- **Q19** Insurance — current and planned
- **Q20** Lease terms for the rented 4–5 ha

🔴 Blocking — fire & safety

- **Q21** Fire management plan — firebreaks, fire-safe water reserve, emergency vehicle access
- **Q22** PMDFCI high-fire-risk zone designation

🟡 Important

- **Q23** Accommodation unit detail beyond PIP — layout, materials, target price
- **Q24** Total expected electrical load (kW/kWh per day)
- **Q25** Sewage/wastewater plan — composting / wetland / septic mix
- **Q26** Top-3 priorities for first 12 months
- **Q27** Minimum viable version of the project
- **Q28** Contingency if PIP delayed 12 months

- **Q29** Physical work undertaken since 2019 acquisition

Of 29 original follow-up questions, the PIP package answered or partially answered 7. Sixteen blocking questions remain. A focused follow-up session with Norbert addressing Q1–Q22 unlocks roadmap drafting.

§ 20

Appendix — Wish List

Norbert's full programme, submitted 2026-03-30 (translated from Polish). Carried here intact — this is the long list, against which scope is staged.

INDEPENDENT ENERGY

Solar panels. Fireplace with water jacket. Three wells. Site-wide water installation.

HALL / WORKSHOP COMPLEX

Trampolines. Storage for excavator, tractor with front loader, mower. Hay storage. Sculpture atelier. Carpentry workshop.

BUILDINGS

Several tiny houses (accommodation). Yoga hall / multi-use space. Shared outdoor kitchen. Paddock.

ACTIVITIES & INFRASTRUCTURE

Site-wide communication. Site-wide lighting. Ski jump / jump ramp. Zip line. Treehouse. Horse trail. Entry gate as sculpture / landmark installation.

SERVICE & GUEST FACILITIES

Five-car garage. Kite equipment room (washing, drying). Outdoor hot shower. En-suite rooms with wardrobes. Multi-functional salon for concerts and performances.

MAIN HOUSE

Mosquito nets and covered porches. Large laundry near kitchen (with view, wardrobe, mangle). Wardrobe at entrance. Exercise / music room (Kamila's). Wood-burning oven plus bread oven. EMF-free zone. Brushed-oak floors.

GARDEN & PERMACULTURE

Greenhouse. Root cellar. Hidden room. Fruit trees (apple, orange, lemon, peach, fig).

ANIMALS & EQUESTRIAN

Four horses (later six). Natural shelters. Paddock and round pen. Horse trail.

OTHER ANIMALS

Chickens. Dogs. Bees.

SAUNA & WELLNESS SPA

Several natural ponds (cold and warm, varying depths). Massage room. Wood-fired sauna.